CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE AT SFO

43

point NPS gap

between passengers reporting a problem and those reporting none

2,809 passengers. One airport. Historical survey evidence.

An independent Python case study using the 2018 SFO customer survey.

Daniel Pantie

2,809 passengers.
97 survey fields.

Real responses and an accompanying data dictionary from SFO and DataSF.

ONE ROW PER PASSENGER

Overall ratings, recommendation, service use and coded problems.

DIFFERENT QUESTIONS

1-5 ratings, 0-10 recommendation and explicit Yes/No answers.

WEIGHTS AND RESPONSE BASES

Each metric uses its own eligible, valid responses.

This is a historical 2018 study. It does not describe current airport performance.

OVERALL EXPERIENCE

80% rated SFO 4 or 5 out of 5

The overall airport rating is positive for most valid respondents.

Overall recommendation

+35 NPS points

Overall ratings and willingness to recommend capture different parts of the experience.

Valid n: 2,625 for overall rating and 2,650 for NPS.

Reported problems coincide with lower recommendation

NPS among respondents with a valid recommendation score:

Reported no problem **+41**

n = 2,181

Reported a problem **-2**

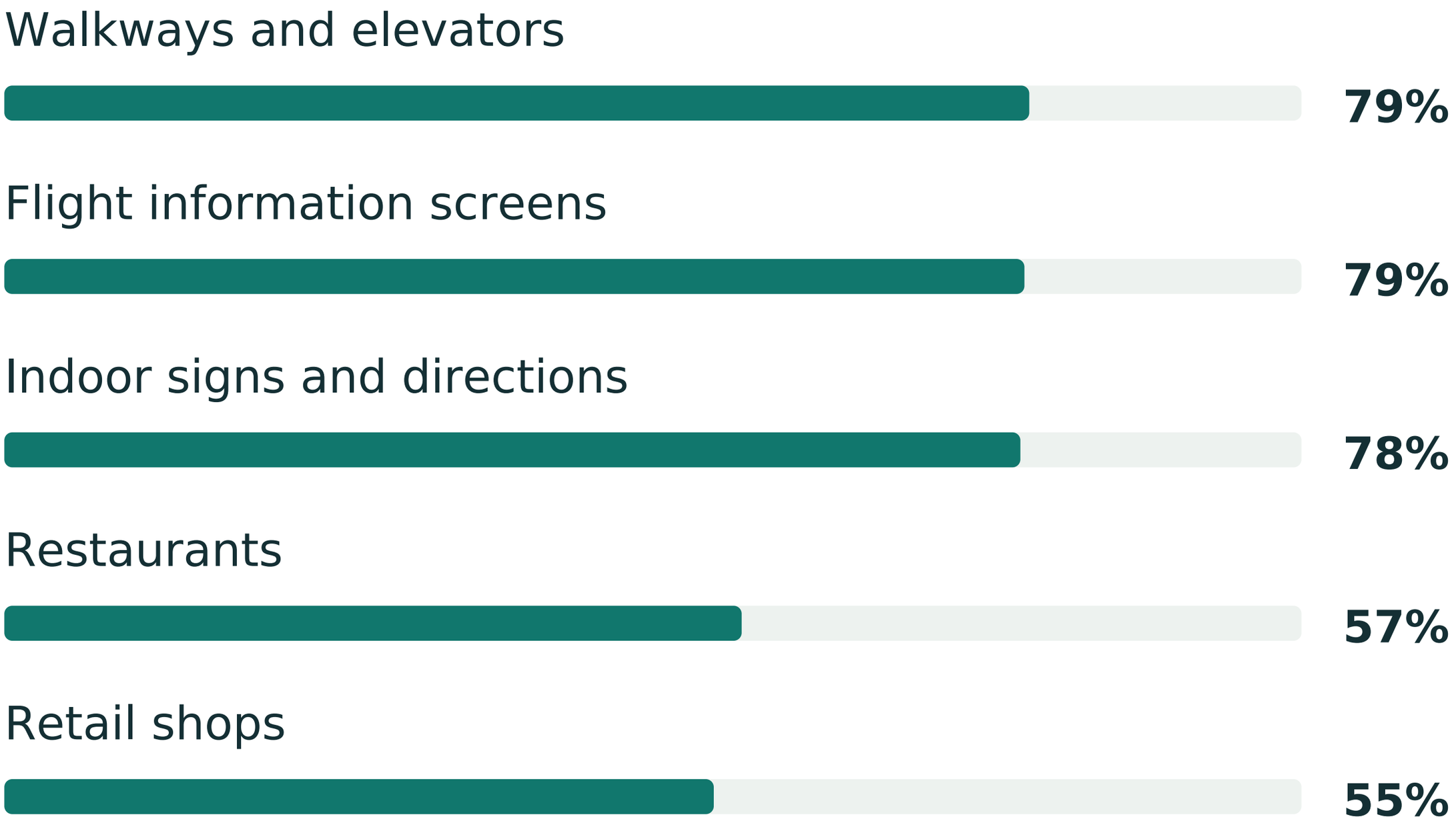
n = 359

Difference: 43.4 points

This comparison is an association. It does not estimate the causal impact of a problem.

Retail and dining received the lowest service ratings

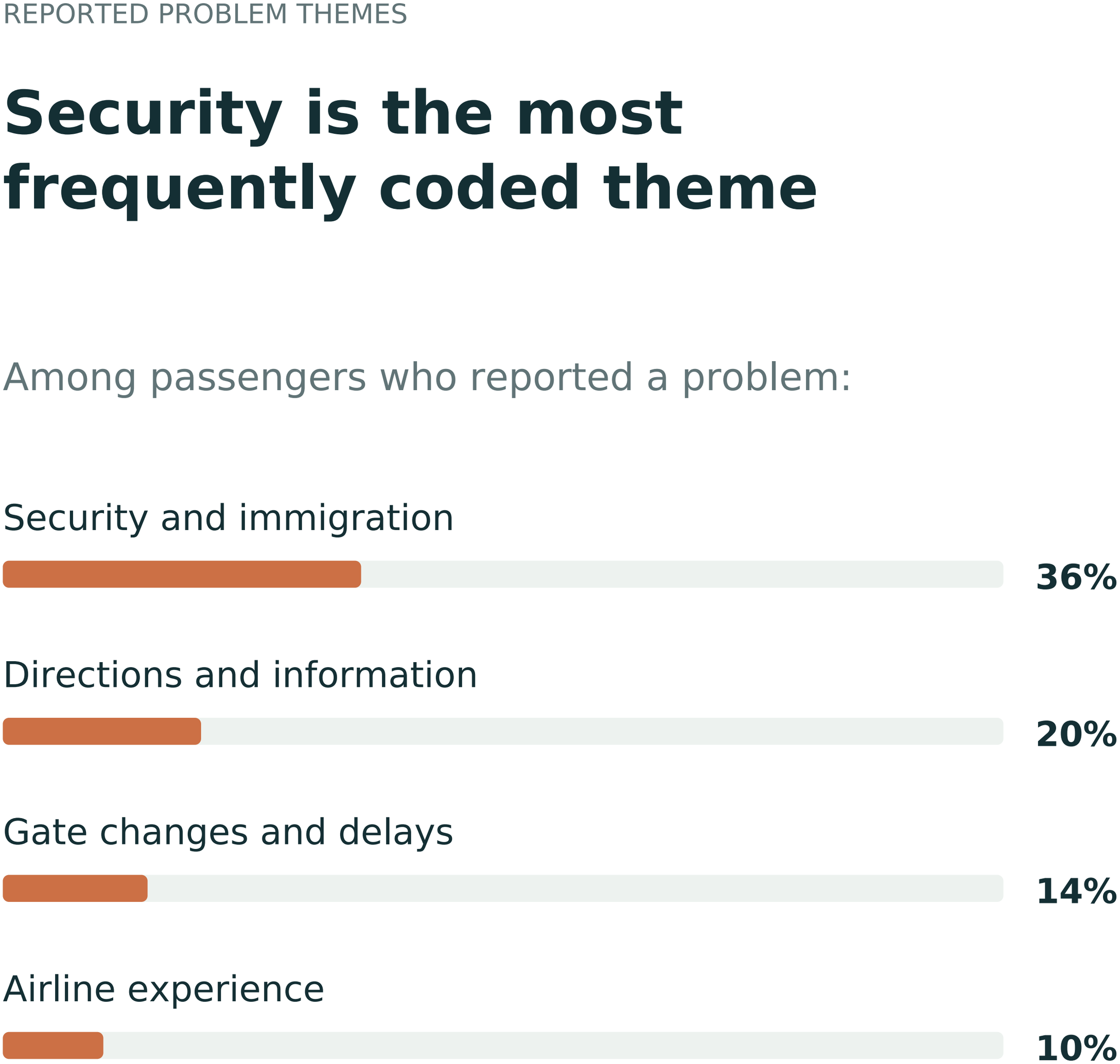
Selected services: strongest three and lowest two. Share rating 4 or 5.



Each service has its own valid response base. Full results appear in the notebook.

Security is the most frequently coded theme

Among passengers who reported a problem:



Base: all 369 problem reporters.

A passenger may appear in more than one theme. 15 problem reporters have no recognized theme code.

Navigation rates higher than security screening

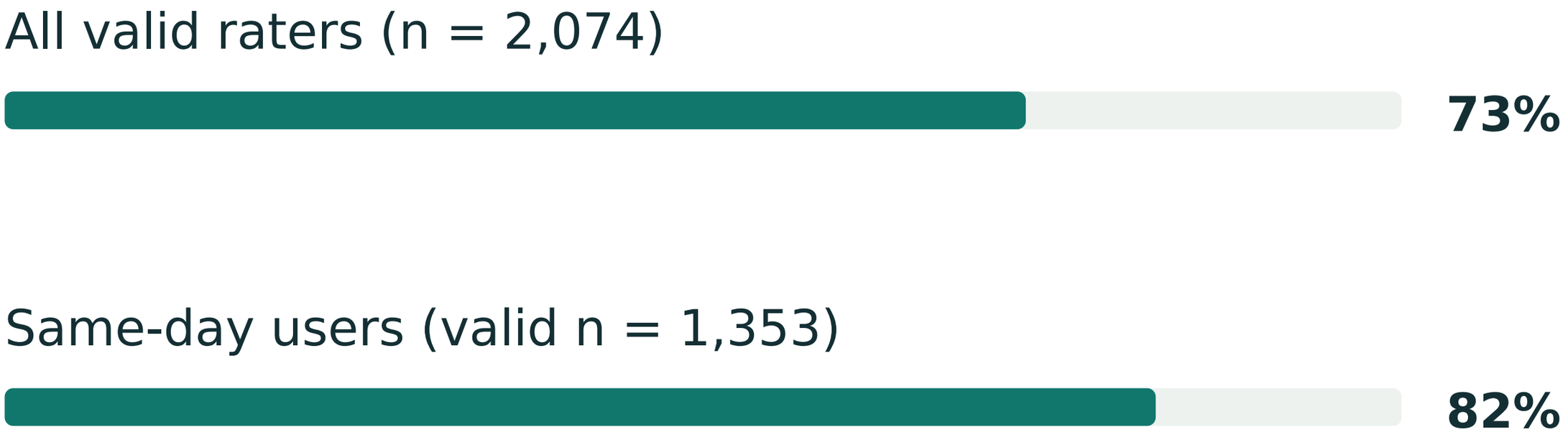
Share rating the experience 4 or 5 on the 1-to-5 difficulty scale:

Valid n = 2,603 for navigation and 2,364 for security screening.

The scale runs from 1 (difficult) to 5 (easy). This is a descriptive comparison.

Wi-Fi ratings change with the response base

Share rating free Wi-Fi 4 or 5:



Usage and rating eligibility need separate definitions.

People who did not use Wi-Fi today may still rate a past experience. Define the population before comparing scores.

Three investigations follow from the evidence

Priorities for follow-up, rather than proven improvement effects:

01 Investigate security pain points

Work with relevant partners to connect complaints with queue and incident records.

02 Examine dining and retail

Ask about value, availability and service before deciding which change to fund.

03 Define actual-user measures

Track digital-service access and completion alongside user-rated experience.

The survey does not quantify revenue uplift or identify which organization caused each problem.

The coding determines the result

Weights, valid response bases and explicit definitions make the analysis reviewable.

RATINGS

1-5 are valid. Exclude 0, 6, literal BLANK and missing ratings.

RECOMMENDATION

0-10 are valid. Code 11 is blank. NPS uses points.

PROBLEM THEMES

Count people once per theme. Include uncoded problem reporters in the base.

The accompanying project includes the executed notebook, full tables, checks and editable text sources.

2018 evidence. Descriptive associations. No causal effects.